



LIONS LIGHT ACADEMY

Escalation & Discipline Policy

Clear Authority, Order, and Restoration

*"It is the glory of God to conceal a matter, but the glory of kings is to
search it out."*

PROVERBS 25:2

EFFECTIVE

September 15, 2026

DOCUMENT

Version 1.2

Purpose & Authority

This policy ensures a safe, orderly, and Christ-centered learning environment at Lions Light Academy (LLA). It supports teacher authority, provides consistent escalation steps, and protects instructional time.

It applies to all co-op days, activities on church property, all off-site LLA events, and LLA class group chats and shared online spaces.

Discipline Philosophy

Discipline priorities at LLA, in order:

- **Safety** — protecting students, staff, and the learning environment
- **Order** — maintaining conditions for instruction and community life
- **Clear Authority** — supporting teacher and leadership responsibility
- **Restoration** — pursued with grace once safety and order are secured

Discipline is corrective, not shaming. The goal is growth and stability for the entire community.

Our aim is never to remove a student. Removal is what happens when keeping them has become impossible, not what we are working toward.

The Student's Responsibility

Learning is the student's work, and nobody can do it for them.

Teachers teach. Parents support. The student has to show up ready, attempt the work, and stay engaged in the room. That responsibility sits with the student and it does not transfer.

LLA is a co-op of active learners. A student who will not carry their part of it is not being served here, and is taking instruction from students who are.

On personal circumstances. Our teachers know their students, and they will use judgment when something real is going on in a student's life. That judgment belongs to the teacher. It is not a claim a student makes to get out of work. Hard weeks happen and are met with grace; a hard week is not a

standing exemption, and repeated appeals to one are themselves a sign of the problem this policy addresses.

Levels of Behavior & Typical Responses

Minor Concerns

Disruptions during class, failure to follow instructions promptly, inappropriate language or tone, misuse of technology.

Response: immediate correction, redirection, reminder of expectations. Not counted.

Repeated minor concerns may be raised to a Moderate concern at the teacher's judgment. There is no fixed number. The teacher decides when a pattern has started costing the class its instruction, says so to the student at the time, and notes what it was based on.

Moderate Concerns

Repeated minor issues, disrespect toward adults or peers, disruption that interferes with instruction, failure to comply after correction, or persistent refusal to take part in instruction.

Work not done. Required work not completed for **two class sessions in a row** is a Moderate concern. The teacher raises it. No permission needed, no review first.

Response: temporary removal from activity if needed, parent notification, documentation.

The warning limit. The first and second Moderate concerns in a school year each carry a documented warning to the family. A **third** begins the Reconciliation Process. Warnings count across all classes, not per teacher, and reset each school year.

Severe Concerns

Unsafe behavior, aggressive actions or threats, defiance that compromises safety or order, behavior requiring immediate leadership involvement.

Response: immediate removal from the learning environment, leadership involvement, same-day parent contact. The student stays supervised until a parent collects them or leadership returns them to the day.

No warnings at this level. One severe incident begins the Reconciliation Process.

Severity determines the response. A severe incident never waits behind a warning count, and repeated minor concerns never become severe by adding up — a teacher may raise them to Moderate, and no further.

Teacher Authority

- Teachers correct behavior immediately and may remove a student from a class or activity to maintain order and safety.
 - Teachers decide when repeated minor concerns rise to a Moderate concern.
 - Teachers decide when work has not been done and raise it.
 - Teachers report Moderate concerns to leadership. Leadership issues the documented warning and notifies the family.
 - Teachers do not determine restoration or removal. Those belong to leadership.
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Escalation Pathway

1. **Teacher / Supervising Adult** — immediate response and initial correction
2. **Principal / Leadership** — review, documentation, next-step determination
3. **Parent / Guardian** — communication and collaborative correction plan
4. **LLA Leadership Team** — patterns, serious incidents, participation decisions

Recusal. Anyone who was the teacher in the incident, is a party to it, or is a relative of the student steps out of the decision.

Stepping Out to Finish Work

A student who arrives without work the class depends on, or falls behind during class, may be sent to finish it in the hallway or lounge and rejoin when it is done.

Supervision. The adult in the main room supervises the hallway. A student works in the teachers lounge only when an adult is already in it — if the lounge is empty, no student goes there. No student is ever sent to a space no adult can see.

This is a routine redirect, not discipline. Nothing is recorded and it counts toward nothing. It protects the lesson for the students who are ready for it.

The Reconciliation Process

Required after any Severe concern, or a third Moderate concern in a school year.

- 1. Pause.** The student steps out of the activity, the co-op day, or the program, as leadership determines.
- 2. Meeting.** Student, parent or guardian, a teacher involved, and leadership meet, in person or by video. Where a student disputes what happened, leadership hears all accounts here and decides what it finds before anything else proceeds.
- 3. Ownership.** The student names what happened and who it affected, in their own words.
- 4. Repair.** A specific action toward whoever was affected, defined by leadership and proportionate to what happened.
- 5. Re-Entry Plan.** Leadership writes down what is expected, in specific behavioral terms. Student and parent sign it.
- 6. Review Period.** Four co-op days the student is present, conduct measured against the plan. Absences extend the period rather than counting toward it.
- 7. Restoration or Conclusion.** Leadership confirms restoration in writing, extends the period once, or determines that continued participation is not workable.

What restoration requires. The signed plan is the standard. A student who owns what happened, makes repair, and meets their plan is restored. What we are hoping for is real change, not just compliance — but the plan is what a student is measured against, so nobody's place here rests on an adult's impression of them.

Completing the process clears the count. A restored student returns with zero warnings.

A family who will not take part cannot complete the process, and participation ends. Leadership will have made reasonable attempts to schedule and given written notice first.

Sustained Unwillingness to Learn

A student who will not take part in learning cannot remain at LLA.

We say it plainly so no family is surprised by it. A student may be asked to leave where they repeatedly do not attempt assigned work, decline to take part in instruction, or continue not participating after the Reconciliation Process has been completed.

This is decided by the Leadership Team, on the record of what actually happened, and never by one adult's opinion on a single bad day. Except where immediate safety requires otherwise, a student is offered the Reconciliation Process before this decision is made.

A student who has decided not to learn does not only lose their own year. They take instruction from the students beside them and from the volunteer teaching the class. We would rather lose one enrollment than let a classroom stop working for everyone in it.

Corrective Actions

Verbal correction and redirection • Temporary removal from class or activity • Parent conference • Structured re-entry expectations • Removal from a co-op day • Conditions for continued participation • Entry into the Reconciliation Process

Documentation & Review

- **Every warning goes to the family in writing.** A short note naming what happened and when is enough. This is what makes a third concern uncontroversial rather than a fight.
- Leadership documents significant incidents, re-entry plans, and restoration confirmations, and gives them to the family in writing.
- Teachers note what a raised pattern was based on, at the time.
- Patterns may be tracked to support accountability and student safety.

A family who disagrees with a warning or a decision may ask leadership to review it. Leadership answers in writing.

The School Year

The school year runs from the first co-op day of the fall term to the last of the spring term. Warning counts reset each year. An open review period is concluded before the year closes and does not carry across the summer.

Continued Participation

LLA reserves the right to set conditions for participation and to determine when removal from the program is necessary to protect students, teachers, and the learning environment. Such decisions are made prayerfully, carefully, and in alignment with the mission and values of the school.

Except where immediate safety requires otherwise, a student is offered the Reconciliation Process before being removed.